

Thursday, 3 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 26° 19°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 23° 17°	MANCHESTER Light rain 21° 16°	GLASGOW Rain 18° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Andy Burnham has faced his first Prime Minister's Questions, with the economy taking centre stage as UK borrowing costs continue to rise.

The Prime Minister highlighted tax cuts already made, including reducing VAT on energy bills and business rates for hospitality. This comes as the country watches closely how the new government addresses financial pressures.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Four people have appeared in court charged with the murder of a newborn baby who was tragically stabbed to death.

The individuals, aged between 19 and 38, are now facing legal proceedings following the heartbreaking incident. This serious case has sent shockwaves across the community.

CRIME · UK
- 3

The doctor described as Lucy Letby's 'boyfriend' during her trial has now been named, after a court order was lifted.

Dr Mark Deakin, a consultant at Alder Hey hospital, was mentioned extensively during the high-profile trial. The lifting of the order allows his identity to be revealed publicly.

JUSTICE · UK
- 4

Around 700 prisoners are set to be released on October 1st, under revised early release plans confirmed by the government.

This new plan adheres to the original schedule for offenders leaving jail, a commitment made by Andy Burnham's government. The move aims to manage prison populations effectively.

JUSTICE · UK
- 5

The King and French President Emmanuel Macron have arrived for an exclusive sneak preview of the landmark Bayeux Tapestry exhibition.

Both leaders are at the British Museum to view the historic tapestry before it opens to the public. This rare joint appearance underscores the cultural significance of the event.

CULTURE · UK

What's coming up

1 **The King and French President Emmanuel Macron have attended a special preview of the Bayeux Tapestry exhibition at the British Museum.**

This rare joint appearance by British and French leaders highlights the cultural significance of the historic tapestry. It's a fantastic moment for arts and heritage.

ON AIR – It's not every day you get two heads of state at a museum preview! What's the most exciting exhibition you've ever seen?

CULTURE · COMING UP

2 **Good news for fans of 'The Other Bennet Sister' – filming has officially wrapped on its upcoming Christmas special!**

The producer confirmed online that three special festive episodes are now in the can. It means we'll have some lovely period drama to look forward to over the holidays.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of Christmas TV specials? What's your go-to festive viewing every year?

TV · COMING UP

3 **Kasabian have invited us into the studio to talk about the unexpected 'third act' of their career, admitting they never thought they'd see success again.**

The rock band are clearly thrilled to be back making music and connecting with fans. It sounds like they've got some great new material on the way.

ON AIR – Which band or artist have you been really pleased to see make a big comeback?

MUSIC · COMING UP

4 **A film about an enigmatic aristocrat is making waves, picking up six nominations for the upcoming Bafta Cymru awards.**

The nominations highlight a strong year for Welsh film and television. It's always great to see homegrown talent getting recognition on a national stage.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of the Baftas? Which film or TV show are you hoping wins big this awards season?

FILM · COMING UP

5 **'Casualty' fans, get ready! A familiar face is set to lead the drama's 40th anniversary special later this month.**

The long-running BBC medical drama will mark the milestone with a special two-part story. It promises to be an unmissable event for loyal viewers.

ON AIR – Forty years! What's the longest-running TV show you've faithfully watched over the years?

TV · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1 Late-night transfer drama on deadline day has sparked a row between Chelsea and Monaco, with both clubs missing out on key players.**

It was a frantic end to the transfer window, with Chelsea, Everton, and Monaco all involved in the fallout. It seems some deals just couldn't be done in time.

ON AIR – Transfer deadline day: thrilling or frustrating? What do you make of all the last-minute drama?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 England have made a change to their squad for the third and final Test against Pakistan, with Brydon Carse being left out.**

The decision comes ahead of the crucial match at Edgbaston. It'll be interesting to see how this impacts the team's strategy for the series decider.

ON AIR – What's your take on England's cricket selection? Who would you have picked for the final Test?

CRICKET · UK
- 3 Manchester City have backed manager Enzo Maresca, signing midfielder Enzo Fernandez from Chelsea in a joint-British record fee.**

This marks the end of the summer's longest-running transfer saga, with City securing a major talent. It's a huge statement of intent from the champions.

ON AIR – A record-breaking transfer! Do you think Enzo Fernandez is worth the money for Manchester City?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Britain's Matthew Brennan has powered to his third stage win at the Vuelta a Espana, dominating a sprint finish on stage 11.**

It's been a fantastic performance from Brennan, showcasing his strength and speed. He's really making a name for himself in this prestigious race.

ON AIR – Three stage wins is incredible! What's been your favourite moment from this year's Vuelta a Espana so far?

CYCLING · UK
- 5 Maia Bouchier starred for England as they thrashed Ireland in a record-breaking win, chasing down a huge total.**

Bouchier hit a magnificent 104 runs to help England achieve a record run chase of 282. It was a dominant performance in the first of three One Day Internationals.

ON AIR – What a performance from Maia Bouchier! Who's your favourite player to watch in women's cricket right now?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The joy of 'sketching in public' is becoming a surprising new hobby for many across the UK.**
Artists of all abilities are finding peace and connection by quietly drawing their surroundings in parks, cafes, and city squares. It's a lovely way to observe the world around you without the pressure of a camera.
- 2 More people are rediscovering the simple pleasure of 'baking their own bread' from scratch.**
The scent of freshly baked loaves filling the kitchen and the satisfying process of kneading dough are proving to be wonderful stress-busters. Plus, there's nothing quite like a warm slice with butter!
- 3 A new trend sees individuals creating 'miniature indoor gardens' in quirky containers.**
From old teacups to clear glass jars, these tiny green worlds bring a touch of nature indoors, even for those with limited space. They're like little pockets of calm on a windowsill.
- 4 The art of 'learning a new language through podcasts' is seeing a boom in popularity.**
Many are choosing to pick up a few phrases of French, Spanish, or even Japanese while commuting or doing household chores. It's a convenient and immersive way to broaden horizons.
- 5 Communities are embracing 'outdoor cinema nights' with classic films projected under the stars.**
It's a delightful way to enjoy a movie with friends and family, wrapped in blankets with a thermos of tea. The shared experience and fresh air add an extra touch of magic.
- 6 A recent study suggests that 'listening to instrumental music' can significantly improve focus and concentration.**
Researchers found that melodic tunes without lyrics allow the brain to engage more deeply with tasks, making it a great soundtrack for work or study. Time to put on some classical or ambient tracks!
- 7 The satisfying craft of 'paper cutting' is gaining new fans, creating intricate designs and artwork.**
Using just a sharp blade and paper, enthusiasts are producing beautiful delicate pieces, from detailed landscapes to abstract patterns. It's a calming and precise art form.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of shampoo will be good, without actually opening the bottle and smelling it first?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GENTLE SHAKE TO SEE HOW IT MOVES INSIDE.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm bath, especially if it's a new bath bomb. What is it?

ANSWER: DOING A QUICK 'TEST SPLASH' WITH ONE TOE TO CHECK THE TEMPERATURE.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a 'particular aroma' can just make you feel instantly nostalgic or incredibly comforted?**

What's that one smell – maybe freshly cut grass, or an old book, or even a specific cleaning product – that always takes you back or brings a smile to your face? Give us a call and share your scent-sational memories!

- **We all have those 'little acts of domestic bravery' that we occasionally pull off around the house, don't we?**

Perhaps you finally tackled that overflowing cupboard, or fixed a leaky tap, or even managed to assemble flat-pack furniture without a single leftover screw! What's your recent triumph of household heroics?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a planet made mostly of diamond, named 55 Cancri e, located about 40 light-years away in the constellation Cancer.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts on the International Space Station have to brush their teeth with special edible toothpaste to avoid creating waste in zero gravity.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£76 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£76 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is considered one of the hardest tongue twisters in the English language.
- The original name for the butterfly was 'flutterby'.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.

On this day

Day 246 of the year, 119 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Blessed Bartholomew Gutierrez; Christian feast day: Blessed Brigida Morello Zancano; Christian feast day: Mansuetus of Toul; Christian feast day: Marinus. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Redfoo, American singer-songwriter, producer, and dancer
- 1964 — Holt McCallany, American actor
- 1969 — John Fugelsang, American comedian, actor, and talk show host
- 1970 — Gareth Southgate, English footballer and manager
- 1944 — Geoff Arnold, English cricketer and coach
- 1981 — Fearne Cotton, English television and radio presenter
- 1956 — Stephen Woolley, English director and producer
- 1933 — Tompall Glaser, American singer-songwriter (died 2013)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1933 — Yevgeniy Abalakov is the first man to reach the highest point in the Soviet Union, Communism Peak (now called Ismoil Somoni Peak and situated in Tajikistan) (7495 m).
- 1989 — Cubana de Aviación Flight 9046 crashes into a residential area of Havana shortly after takeoff from José Martí International Airport, killing 150.
- 1954 — The People's Liberation Army begins shelling the Republic of China-controlled islands of Quemoy, starting the First Taiwan Strait Crisis.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1943 — World War II: British and Canadian troops land on the Italian mainland. On the same day, Walter Bedell Smith and Giuseppe Castellano sign the Armistice of Cassibile, although it is not announced for another five days.
- 1971 — Qatar becomes an independent state.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1941 — The Holocaust: Karl Fritzsche, deputy camp commandant of the Auschwitz concentration camp, experiments with the use of Zyklon B in the gassing of Soviet POWs.

- 1945 — A three-day celebration begins in China, following the Victory over Japan Day on September 2.
- 1989 — Varig Flight 254 crashes in the Amazon rainforest near São José do Xingu in Brazil, killing 12.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 247 of the year, 118 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Candida the Elder; Christian feast day: Blessed Catherine of Racconigi; Christian feast day: Blessed Dina Bélanger; Christian feast day: Hermione of Ephesus. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1977 — Lucie Silvas, English singer-songwriter and pianist
- 1996 — Jordan Lilley, English rugby league player
- 1960 — Kim Thayil, American guitarist and songwriter
- 1994 — Thomas Minns, English rugby player
- 1993 — Emma Brownlie, Scottish footballer
- 1928 — Dick York, American actor (died 1992)
- 1981 — Beyoncé, American singer-songwriter
- 1978 — Wes Bentley, American actor and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2024 — A 14-year-old gunman kills four people and injures seven in a mass shooting at Apalachee High School near Winder, Georgia.
- 1977 — The Golden Dragon massacre takes place in San Francisco.
- 1972 — The Price Is Right premieres on CBS. It currently is the longest running game show on American television.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1967 — Vietnam War: Operation Swift begins when U.S. Marines engage the North Vietnamese in battle in the Que Son Valley.
- 1964 — Scotland's Forth Road Bridge near Edinburgh officially opens.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
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FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
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FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
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FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
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FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar